

opportunity to scale an open source business, which is encouraging for future startups.

In the past, investors claimed that open source had very limited growth opportunity. But this has changed in the past five years, with more and more VCs being open to investing in startups that rely on the open source business model. This has given the community in India an impetus to keep contributing to open source so that more businesses can leverage it.

The Red Hat acquisition also highlights how one can build a successful business based on open source which, in this case, was to take an open source product and build a service and support model on top of it. Apart from building revenue, open source also enables real economies of scale. So when an organisation or startup builds a project, a small core member team lays the foundation stone, while the rest of

the community does the crux of the work and tries to better it.

For instance, developers in Germany may want code that was built in India. And they may want to localise it because that is the only way it could be used at their front-end. With this, you suddenly have German support and the functionality of your product has expanded without any further investment in resources. Across the globe, there are suddenly 5,000 customers who are now using your product. This interconnectedness is what is helping open source businesses become viable and lucrative investment opportunities for VCs.

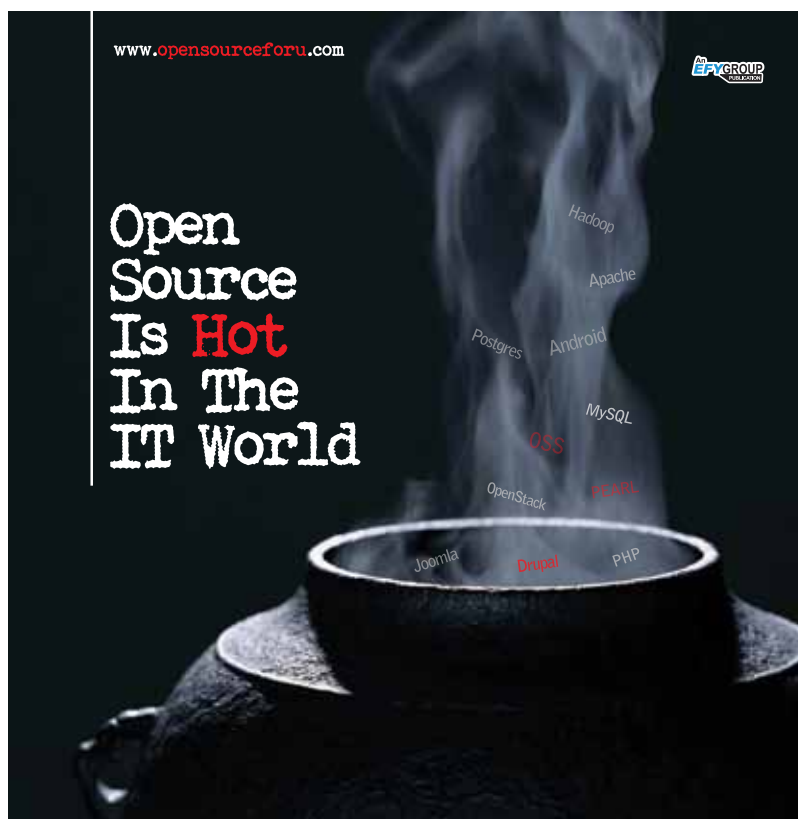
Paving the way

India has the fastest growing open source contribution on GitHub globally and that speaks a lot about how the whole ecosystem is changing. Most importantly, the interconnected community is the real propeller of the open source wave that is taking over the world. You might be working to solve a really small problem now, but you have no idea how and where that will be picked up. Sharing your code and engaging the community to work on it to make it better is one of the greatest advantages of embracing open source, as it will open the way for how to get the most out of it. **END** 🐧

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The author is general manager at GitHub India. This article is based on the talk titled 'The Interconnected Community Powering India' that he gave at the virtual edition of OSI 2021 in October last year.

Transcribed and curated by: Siddha Dhar



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